

FL BEST TRAINER LLC

Independent for Life

The 6-Week Strength Foundations for Adults 50+

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FLBestTrainer.com

The Training Program — 18 Sessions

The full program. 18 sessions over six weeks — the same sessions, standards, and Day 42 tests for everyone. Coaching members train in small cohorts with form checks; self-study members run the identical plan on their own schedule. Show up for all 18 sessions; the program handles the rest.

The promise (read this first)

Six weeks from now, you will do three things you may not be able to do today:

1. **Stand from a chair without using your hands** — 5 clean reps, no pushing off your knees.
2. **Carry 20 lbs across the room** — two 10-lb weights, steady walk, tall posture.
3. **Hold a 30-second single-leg stand** — unassisted, both legs.

That's the program. Not "get fit." Not "tone up." Three concrete, testable abilities that mean independence in daily life — getting up from any chair, carrying groceries, and trusting your balance. You'll test all three on Day 1 and again on Day 42. Your numbers are the proof.

Who this is for: adults 50+ who finished the 4-Week Starter Plan (or equivalent training). This is the next level: real progressive loading, new movement patterns, and a test at the end that means something.

What you need: - A sturdy chair with no wheels - A clear wall and a kitchen counter - Dumbbells: a light pair (3–5 lb) and a heavier pair (8–10 lb) by Week 3 — the 20-lb carry needs two 10-lb weights - A bottom stair with a handrail (standard ~7-inch rise) - A wooden dowel, broomstick, or PVC pipe (for the hip hinge — any straight stick works) - Clear floor space, a clear walking path, supportive closed-toe shoes

How this connects to the starter plan: everything carries over — the one-cue-per-rep rule, the chair-always-there rule, breathing out on the effort, spine neutral under load. The starter plan taught you the movements. This program loads them.

Safety — non-negotiable

1. **Doctor clearance.** If you have a heart condition, uncontrolled blood pressure, dizziness or fainting, joint replacements, osteoporosis, or anything that makes you unsure — get cleared before Day 1, and bring the checklist from the 7-day guide.

2. **Pain is a stop sign.** Muscle effort and fatigue are fine. Sharp pain, joint pain, chest pain, or dizziness: stop immediately, sit down.
 3. **Breathe.** Exhale on the effort, inhale on the easy part. Never hold your breath and strain — this matters more as the weights get heavier.
 4. **Spine neutral under load.** We never bend or twist the spine with weight. Hips and legs move; the back stays long and still.
 5. **Balance work is always protected.** A wall, chair, or counter is within reach for every balance exercise. Eyes open, always.
 6. **Load is earned.** You add weight only when you can finish all prescribed reps with perfect form and feel 2-3 clean reps still in the tank. The program tells you when to consider more weight — your form confirms it. This is the beauty of weights: the same exercise challenges any level — water bottles today, dumbbells next month, heavier dumbbells after that. The load changes; the movement doesn't.
 7. **This is exercise instruction, not medical advice.** When in doubt, ask your doctor or your coach — don't guess with your body.
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How the 6 weeks work

The schedule. Three 30-minute sessions a week on non-consecutive days (Mon / Wed / Fri works). Same three session types every week:

- **Session A — Lower body + carry** (squat, hinge, step, carry)
- **Session B — Upper body + core** (push, pull, press, trunk)
- **Session C — Full body + balance** (everything, balance emphasis)

The arc. - Weeks 1-2 — Baseline + build. Day 1 tests all three guarantee abilities. Two rounds (Week 1), three rounds (Week 2). Own every movement. - **Weeks 3-4 — Load.** Heavier dumbbells join the big patterns. The hip hinge gets serious. Carry weight and distance climb. Unassisted chair-stand practice begins. - **Weeks 5-6 — Peak + prove.** Week 5 is the hardest week — closest to the test. Week 6 tapers (lighter, sharper), and Session 18 is the guarantee test: all three abilities, measured.

The three tests (Day 1 and Day 42): 1. **Chair stand:** arms crossed over chest, sturdy chair — how many full stand-ups without using your hands? (Goal: 5 clean reps.) 2. **Carry:** two 10-lb weights (or the heaviest you can hold with perfect posture on Day 1 — record it), walk ~20 feet and back. (Goal: 20 lbs total, steady, tall.) 3. **Single-leg stand:** near a wall, unassisted, each leg. (Goal: 30 seconds per leg.)

The movement library

Every movement: **setup**, **key cue** (the one thing to think about), **common mistake**, **regression** (easier), **progression** (harder), and **skip if** (when to choose a different movement).

Squat pattern — the chair stand

1. Chair squat → unassisted sit-to-stand → goblet squat Setup: Feet hip-width apart, chair behind your calves. Sit back until your buttocks lightly touch the chair; stand without plopping.

KEY CUE sit back like you're finding the chair behind you; knees track over toes.

COMMON MISTAKE knees caving inward, chest collapsing. "Chest proud, knees out."

REGRESSION hold a chair or counter; sit to a higher surface. Progression ladder (this is the program's spine): 1. Hands-assisted chair squat 2. Fingertips-only on the chair 3. Arms crossed, unassisted — **this is Test 1** 4. Arms crossed, slower tempo (3 seconds down) 5. Goblet squat — dumbbell held at chest 6. Heavier goblet squat

SKIP IF deep knee bending is painful — shorten the range, stay pain-free, and tell your coach.

Hinge pattern — picking things up safely

2. Dowel hip hinge → dumbbell Romanian deadlift Setup: Stand tall, dowel held vertically along your back touching head, upper back, and tailbone (three points of contact). Feet hip-width, soft knees. Push your hips straight back — the dowel stays glued to all three points — until you feel a stretch in the hamstrings. Squeeze the glutes to stand.

KEY CUE the dowel never leaves your back. If it does, your spine moved — reset.

COMMON MISTAKE bending at the waist (dowel leaves the tailbone) or squatting instead of hinging (knees travel far forward). Hips go BACK, like closing a car door with your butt.

REGRESSION face a wall an arm's length away and reach your hips back to touch it (wall-touch hinge); or do it holding the chair.

PROGRESSION dowel hinge → dumbbells at your sides (Romanian deadlift), light → heavier. Weight never exceeds what your flat back can handle.

SKIP IF hamstring or lower-back pain with the hinge — shorten the range and tell your coach. This pattern is non-negotiable for safe lifting in daily life, so we fix it rather than skip it.

Single-leg strength

3. Step-up Setup: Bottom stair (~7-inch rise), hand on the rail. Step up, bring the other foot up, step down with control. All reps one leg, then switch.

KEY CUE push through the heel of the working leg — don't push off the back foot.

COMMON MISTAKE pushing off the trailing foot. The working leg does the work.

REGRESSION lower platform (sturdy thick book), both hands on support.

PROGRESSION slower step-down (3s); light dumbbells at sides; slightly higher step with rail.

SKIP IF knee/hip replacement within 12 months without specific clearance for step-ups.

4. Reverse step-back (split stance) Setup: Stand behind your chair, hands resting on the back. Step one foot straight back ~2 feet, lower the back knee toward the floor (it doesn't need to touch), front knee stays over the ankle. Push through the front heel to return.

KEY CUE tall torso, front knee over the ankle — the step back is long enough that the knee never passes the toes.

COMMON MISTAKE stepping too short, which drives the front knee forward. Long step back, torso tall.

REGRESSION smaller step back, shallow depth; hold the chair firmly.

PROGRESSION deeper; slower tempo; light dumbbells at sides.

SKIP IF the back knee touching down is painful — limit depth to pain-free range. (We use reverse step-backs instead of forward lunges deliberately: stepping back keeps the load on the front leg's hip and off the knee.)

5. Standing hip abduction Setup: Sideways to the chair, inside hand on the back. Working leg straight, toes forward, lift 6–8 inches to the side. Lower slowly.

KEY CUE stand tall — don't lean away from the lifting leg.

COMMON MISTAKE leaning the torso to lift higher. Smaller lift, tall torso.

REGRESSION 3–4 inch lift.

PROGRESSION hover the hand; 2-second hold at the top.

6. Calf raise Setup: Behind the chair, hands on the back. Rise onto the balls of your feet, pause, lower fully.

KEY CUE full range, no bouncing. Pause at the bottom every rep.

COMMON MISTAKE bouncing off the bottom.

REGRESSION smaller range.

PROGRESSION single-leg with both hands on the chair; 2-second pause at top.

Push

7. Countertop push-up → low-incline push-up Setup: Hands on the counter at shoulder width, body a straight line from head to heels. Bend elbows to ~45°, chest toward the counter, press back.

KEY CUE straight line — squeeze glutes and belly so the hips don't sag.

COMMON MISTAKE sagging hips or flared elbows.

REGRESSION wall push-up (more upright).

PROGRESSION countertop → sturdy low table or bench (lower incline = harder; test stability first — it must not slide or tip). Then: feet farther back, slower tempo, added reps. We do not program floor push-ups in this plan — incline loading builds the same muscles with far less wrist and shoulder risk.

SKIP IF shoulder pain — stay more upright, shorten range, stay pain-free.

Pull

8. Dumbbell bent row Setup: Facing the chair, one hand on the seat, opposite foot back, back flat like a tabletop. Pull the dumbbell to the ribcage, squeeze the shoulder blade, lower slowly.

KEY CUE pinch the pencil between your shoulder blades at the top.

COMMON MISTAKE rounding the back or shrugging. Back flat, shoulder away from the ear.

REGRESSION lighter weight; smaller range.

PROGRESSION heavier dumbbell; 2-second squeeze at the top.

SKIP IF bending forward bothers your back — do it seated, leaning slightly forward.

9. Face pull (band) Loop a resistance band at face height — a door anchor or a sturdy post. Hold both ends, step back until the band is lightly taut, arms reaching straight ahead. Pull the band toward your forehead, elbows high and wide, until your hands finish beside your ears. Return slowly.

KEY CUE row to your forehead, not your chest — elbows high, knuckles up at the finish.

COMMON MISTAKE pulling low to the chin and shrugging. Light band, high path.

REGRESSION step closer (less tension); smaller range.

PROGRESSION 2-second hold beside your ears; 3-second return.

SKIP IF you don't own a band yet — the row covers the big pulling muscles. This is the shoulder-health bonus. Band check: look the band over and tug-test the anchor before your first set — bands snap and slip. If the pull pinches or grinds inside the shoulder joint, stop; and with a rotator-cuff history, clear this one with your clinician first.

Press

10. Dumbbell overhead press Setup: Seated tall or standing (chair in front for balance). Dumbbells at shoulder height, press overhead without arching the back, lower slowly.

KEY CUE ribs down — don't arch to get the weight up.

COMMON MISTAKE leaning back. If you must lean, the weight is too heavy.

REGRESSION seated; lighter; press to forehead height only.

PROGRESSION standing; heavier; slower lowering.

SKIP IF overhead reaching bothers your shoulders — substitute the **standing chest press** (press dumbbells forward from chest height, same ribs-down cue). Pain-free range is the rule; shoulders that complain about overhead work are telling the truth.

Core (spine-safe — no crunches, no loaded bending)

11. Dead bug Setup: On your back, arms to the ceiling, knees bent, feet flat. Press the lower back into the floor. Slide one heel out, return, alternate.

KEY CUE back glued to the floor the entire set.

COMMON MISTAKE back arching as the leg extends. Shorter slide, flat back — always.

REGRESSION tiny 2–3 inch slides.

PROGRESSION farther slides; full dead bug (feet off floor, opposite arm/leg extend) only if the back stays glued.

SKIP IF floor work is difficult — substitute standing march with a braced belly.

12. Bird dog Setup: On hands and knees (hands under shoulders, knees under hips), back flat like a tabletop. Extend one arm forward and the opposite leg back until both are in line with the torso. Hold 3–5 seconds, return with control, alternate.

KEY CUE long spine — imagine balancing a glass of water on your lower back.

COMMON MISTAKE hips rocking side to side or the lower back sagging. Smaller extension, still spine.

REGRESSION extend only the leg (hands stay down); or only the arm.

PROGRESSION longer holds (up to 10 seconds); more reps.

SKIP IF knees bother you on the floor — do it standing: hold the chair, extend one leg straight back a few inches with a flat back (same long-spine cue).

Carry — independence strength

13. Farmer's carry → 20-lb carry Setup: A dumbbell in each hand at your sides. Shoulders back and down, ribs down, gaze forward. Walk slowly ~20 feet and back. Support within reach along the path.

KEY CUE tall posture the whole walk — don't let the weights pull you forward or shrug you up.

COMMON MISTAKE shrugging or leaning forward. Reset posture every few steps if needed.

REGRESSION lighter weights; shorter distance; posture walk (empty hands). Progression ladder (the program's second spine): 1. Posture walk, empty hands, 30s 2. Water bottles, 30s 3. Light dumbbells (3–5 lb each), 40s 4. Moderate (5–8 lb each), 60s 5. **Two 10-lb dumbbells (20 lbs total), 60s+ — this is Test 2**

SKIP IF grip fails first — that's normal and it improves; shorten the distance, keep the posture. Never sacrifice posture for weight.

14. Suitcase carry (single-sided) Setup: One dumbbell in one hand at your side. Walk slowly, resisting the urge to lean away from the weight — stay perfectly upright.

KEY CUE don't lean. The weight tries to tip you; your trunk says no.

COMMON MISTAKE leaning away from the weight. Shorten the distance before you lean.

REGRESSION lighter weight; shorter distance.

PROGRESSION heavier; longer.

SKIP IF lateral trunk pain — stay bilateral (farmer's) instead.

Balance — the 30-second stand

15. Single-leg stand → 30-second stand Setup: Near a wall. Lift one foot a few inches. Fingertips on the wall are fine to start.

KEY CUE pick one spot on the wall and stare at it. Keep breathing.

COMMON MISTAKE holding the breath. Tension without breath-holding. Progression ladder (the program's third spine): 1. Kickstand (toe lightly touching floor) 2. Fingertips on the wall 3. Hover hand an inch off the wall 4. Unassisted, 10s → 20s → **30s per leg — this is Test 3**

SKIP IF never unprotected — a wall or chair is always within reach, eyes open always.

16. Heel-to-toe walk Setup: Slow heel-to-toe steps along a wall, eyes forward.

KEY CUE eyes forward, not down — balance follows the gaze.

REGRESSION heel-to-instep; fingertips on wall.

PROGRESSION longer distance; slower steps.

17. Weight shift Setup: Feet hip-width, chair in front. Slowly shift all weight onto one foot, feel it arrive, shift back.

KEY CUE feel the weight arrive fully before shifting back. Slow is the point.

REGRESSION hands on chair; partial shifts.

PROGRESSION narrow stance; hover hands.

18. Standing march (loaded) Setup: Behind the chair. Lift one knee toward hip height, lower with control, alternate, tall torso.

KEY CUE tall — no leaning back as the knee rises.

REGRESSION small lift; firm grip.

PROGRESSION hover hands; light dumbbells at sides.

The 18 sessions

Same clock every session: **warm-up 5 min → main block ~20 min → cool-down 5 min.**

Warm-up and cool-down never change (printed in full in Session 1). Rest 60-90 seconds between rounds; rest as needed otherwise. The clock is a guide, not a boss.

Standard warm-up (5 min): march in place 60s (chair nearby) → arm circles 30s forward + 30s back → hip circles 30s each direction → ankle rolls 30s per foot → gentle torso twists 30s → shoulder rolls 30s → 5 easy chair squats (wake up the pattern).

Standard cool-down (5 min): standing quad stretch holding chair 30s/leg → calf stretch against wall 30s/leg → chest opener (fingers interlaced behind back, lift gently) 30s → standing hamstring stretch 30s/leg → neck rolls + slow deep breathing 60s.

WEEK 1 — Baseline + build (2 rounds)

Day 1 tests all three guarantee abilities before the warm-up. Write everything down — Week 6 compares against today.

Session 1 — A: Lower + carry (+ BASELINE TEST)

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby ☐ walking path clear ☐ dumbbells where you can reach them. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Baseline test (10 min, before the warm-up): 1. **Chair stand:** arms crossed, sturdy chair — max full stand-ups without hands: reps 2. **Carry: heaviest pair you can walk with in perfect posture, ~20 ft and back — weight: lbs, posture held? Y / N** 3. **Single-leg stand: near wall, best unassisted hold per leg — right: s, left: s**

Warm-up (5 min): March in place 60s, chair nearby, easy pace. Arm circles 30s forward, 30s back. Hip circles 30s each direction. Ankle rolls 30s per foot. Gentle torso twists 30s. Shoulder rolls 30s. 5 easy chair squats.

Main block — 2 rounds: 1. Chair squat × 10 (hands as needed — note your level on the ladder) — sit back, knees over toes 2. Dowel hip hinge × 10 — dowel never leaves your back 3. Step-up × 8 per leg (hand on rail) — push through the heel 4. Calf raise × 12 — full range, no bounce 5. Farmer's carry — posture walk, empty hands, 30s — tall the whole walk 6. Single-leg stand — best comfortable hold per leg (note it) — stare at one spot, keep breathing Rest 60-90s between rounds.

Cool-down (5 min): quad stretch 30s/leg → calf stretch 30s/leg → chest opener 30s → hamstring stretch 30s/leg → neck rolls + breathing 60s.

Session 2 — B: Upper + core

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up (5 min): march 60s → arm circles 30s fwd/30s back → hip circles 30s each way → ankle rolls 30s/foot → torso twists 30s → shoulder rolls 30s → 5 easy wall push-ups.

Main block — 2 rounds: 1. Countertop push-up × 10 — straight line, elbows 45° 2. Dumbbell bent row × 10 per arm (light) — pinch the pencil 3. Overhead press × 10 (light, seated or standing — your call; shoulder flag applies) — ribs down 4. Dead bug × 8 per side — back glued down 5. Bird dog × 6 per side (3-5s holds) — long spine, glass of water 6. Standing march × 10 per leg — tall, no lean-back 7. Face pull (band) × 12 — elbows high, forehead finish

Rest 60-90s between rounds.

Cool-down (5 min): standard.

Session 3 — C: Full body + balance

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby ☐ walking path clear. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up (5 min): standard.

Main block — 2 rounds: 1. Chair squat × 10 — sit back, knees over toes 2. Countertop push-up × 8 — straight line 3. Dumbbell bent row × 8 per arm (light) — pinch the pencil 4. Dowel hip hinge × 10 — dowel glued to your back 5. Farmer's carry — water bottles or light dumbbells, 30s — tall posture 6. Heel-to-toe walk — 30s along the wall — eyes forward 7. Single-leg stand — 20s per leg (or your best hold) — stare, breathe

Rest 60-90s between rounds.

Cool-down (5 min): standard.

End of Week 1: you own the movements and you have your baseline numbers. Text your coach your three test results — that's your starting line.

WEEK 2 — Build volume (3 rounds)

Same movements, same loads. The only change: 3 rounds. Expect honest tiredness the next day — that's work capacity building.

Session 4 — A: Lower + carry

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby ☐ walking path clear. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up: standard. **Main — 3 rounds:** chair squat ×10 → dowel hinge ×10 → step-up ×8/leg → calf raise ×12 → farmer's carry (water bottles or light dumbbells, 40s) → single-leg stand (best hold/leg). Rest 60–90s between rounds. **Cool-down:** standard.

Session 5 — B: Upper + core

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up: standard. **Main — 3 rounds:** countertop push-up ×10 → row ×10/arm (light) → press ×10 (light) → dead bug ×8/side → bird dog ×6/side → standing march ×10/leg → face pull (band) ×12. Rest 60–90s between rounds. **Cool-down:** standard.

Session 6 — C: Full body + balance

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby ☐ walking path clear. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up: standard. **Main — 3 rounds:** chair squat ×10 → countertop push-up ×8 → row ×8/arm (light) → dowel hinge ×10 → farmer's carry (water bottles or light dumbbells, 40s) → heel-to-toe walk 30s → single-leg stand (best hold/leg). Rest 60–90s between rounds. **Cool-down:** standard.

End of Week 2: three rounds of everything, done. Your body now believes you. Text your coach one movement that feels solid and one that needs work — the Week 3 loading plan adjusts to your answer.

WEEK 3 — Load it (2 rounds, heavier where earned)

Back to 2 rounds. Dumbbells get heavier on the big patterns — but only where your form earned it. The hinge goes from dowel to dumbbells. Carry weight climbs. Unassisted chair-stand practice starts: every squat set begins with 3 unassisted reps (arms crossed), then hands as needed for the rest.

Session 7 — A: Lower + carry

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby ☐ walking path clear ☐ light + heavier dumbbells ready. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up: standard.

Main — 2 rounds: 1. Chair squat × 10 — first 3 reps arms crossed (unassisted practice), remainder hands as needed — sit back, knees over toes 2. Dumbbell Romanian deadlift × 10 (light dumbbells) — dowel-learned pattern: hips back, back flat 3. Step-up × 8 per leg (3s down) — push through the heel 4. Reverse step-back × 6 per leg — long step, tall torso, front knee over ankle 5. Calf raise × 12 — full range 6. Farmer's carry — light dumbbells (3-5 lb each), 40s — tall, shoulders back and down 7. Single-leg stand — hover-hand practice, best hold per leg — stare, breathe

Rest 60-90s between rounds. **Cool-down:** standard.

Session 8 — B: Upper + core

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up: standard.

Main — 2 rounds: 1. Countertop push-up × 10 (2s pause at the counter) — straight line 2. Dumbbell bent row × 10 per arm (heavier if earned) — pinch the pencil, 2s squeeze 3. Overhead press × 10 (heavier if earned; seated is fine — shoulder flag) — ribs down 4. Dead bug × 8 per side (slower) — back glued down 5. Bird dog × 8 per side (5s holds) — long spine 6. Standing march × 10 per leg (light dumbbells at sides, if steady) — tall 7. Face pull (band) × 12 — elbows high, forehead finish

Rest 60-90s between rounds. **Cool-down:** standard.

Session 9 — C: Full body + balance

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby ☐ walking path clear. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up: standard.

Main — 2 rounds: 1. Chair squat × 10 (first 3 unassisted) 2. Countertop push-up × 8 3. Dumbbell bent row × 8 per arm 4. Dumbbell Romanian deadlift × 10 (light) 5. Farmer's carry — light dumbbells, 45s 6. Suitcase carry — one light dumbbell, 20s per side — don't lean 7. Heel-to-toe walk — 45s — eyes forward 8. Single-leg stand — best hold per leg

Rest 60–90s between rounds. **Cool-down:** standard.

End of Week 3: you're loading real patterns now. Text your coach your carry weight and your unassisted chair-stand count — Week 4 builds on exactly those numbers.

WEEK 4 — Strength (2 rounds, lower reps, heavier)

The strength block. Reps drop, weights rise (where form allows), tempo slows to 3-1-3 on the big lifts. This is where the chair stand and the carry make their biggest jumps. Every squat set: 5 unassisted reps to start, then assistance as needed.

Session 10 — A: Lower + carry

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby ☐ walking path clear. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up: standard.

Main — 2 rounds, 3-1-3 tempo on lifts: 1. Chair squat × 8 — first 5 reps arms crossed — sit back, knees over toes 2. Dumbbell Romanian deadlift × 8 (heavier if earned) — hips back, flat back 3. Step-up × 6 per leg (light dumbbells at sides, if steady) — heel of the working leg 4. Reverse step-back × 6 per leg (3s down) — long step, tall 5. Standing hip abduction × 10 per leg (2s hold at top) — don't lean 6. Farmer's carry — moderate dumbbells (5–8 lb each), 60s — tall 7. Single-leg stand — unassisted attempts, best hold per leg — stare, breathe

Rest 60–90s between rounds. **Cool-down:** standard.

Session 11 — B: Upper + core

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up: standard.

Main — 2 rounds, 3-1-3 tempo: 1. Low-incline push-up × 8 (countertop, or lower incline if earned and stable) — straight line 2. Dumbbell bent row × 8 per arm (heavier if earned) — pinch, squeeze 2s 3. Overhead press × 8 (heavier if earned) — ribs down 4. Dead bug × 6 per side (slow) — back glued 5. Bird dog × 8 per side (8s holds) — long spine 6. Standing march × 8 per leg (dumbbells at sides) — tall 7. Face pull (band) × 12 — elbows high, forehead finish
Rest 60–90s between rounds. **Cool-down:** standard.

Session 12 — C: Full body + balance

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby ☐ walking path clear. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up: standard.

Main — 2 rounds: 1. Chair squat × 8 (first 5 unassisted) 2. Low-incline push-up × 8 3. Dumbbell bent row × 8 per arm 4. Dumbbell Romanian deadlift × 8 5. Farmer's carry — moderate dumbbells, 60s 6. Suitcase carry — moderate dumbbell, 30s per side — don't lean 7. Heel-to-toe walk — 60s 8. Single-leg stand — unassisted, best hold per leg

Rest 60–90s between rounds. **Cool-down:** standard.

End of Week 4 — mid-program check: retest your three abilities informally (no pressure, just data) and text your coach the numbers. Week 5 is the peak — it should feel like the hardest week. That's the design.

WEEK 5 — Peak (3 rounds, heaviest)

The hardest week. Three rounds, heaviest loads of the program, longest carries, longest balance holds. If a session feels like a lot — good. Week 6 backs off and then you test. Do not add extra sessions this week; recovery is part of the program.

Session 13 — A: Lower + carry

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby ☐ walking path clear. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up: standard.

Main — 3 rounds: 1. Chair squat × 10 — first 5+ reps arms crossed (as many unassisted as you own) — sit back, knees over toes 2. Goblet squat × 8 (dumbbell at chest — the next rung) — chest proud, knees out 3. Dumbbell Romanian deadlift × 8 — hips back, flat back 4. Step-up × 8 per leg — heel of the working leg 5. Reverse step-back × 8 per leg — long step, tall 6. Farmer's carry — 8–10 lb each hand, 60s — tall, shoulders down 7. Single-leg stand — unassisted, 25s target per leg — stare, breathe

Rest 60–90s between rounds. **Cool-down:** standard.

Session 14 — B: Upper + core

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up: standard.

Main — 3 rounds: 1. Low-incline push-up × 10 — straight line 2. Dumbbell bent row × 10 per arm — pinch, squeeze 3. Overhead press × 10 — ribs down 4. Dead bug × 8 per side — back glued 5. Bird dog × 10 per side (8–10s holds) — long spine 6. Standing march × 10 per leg (dumbbells at sides) — tall 7. Face pull (band) × 12 — elbows high, forehead finish

Rest 60–90s between rounds. **Cool-down:** standard.

Session 15 — C: Full body + balance

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby ☐ walking path clear. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up: standard.

Main — 3 rounds: 1. Chair squat × 10 (max unassisted to start) 2. Goblet squat × 8 3. Low-incline push-up × 8 4. Dumbbell bent row × 8 per arm 5. Dumbbell Romanian deadlift × 8 6. Farmer's carry — 8–10 lb each hand, 75s 7. Suitcase carry — 8–10 lb, 30s per side — don't lean 8. Heel-to-toe walk — 60s 9. Single-leg stand — unassisted, 25–30s per leg

Rest 60–90s between rounds. **Cool-down:** standard.

End of Week 5: that's the peak — the hardest training of the program is behind you. Week 6 is taper and test. Sleep well, eat well, and text your coach how the 20-lb carry practice felt.

A note before the taper: your training after Day 42

Week 6 is taper, test, and prove it. But start thinking now about what comes after — because the worst outcome of this program isn't missing a test, it's going back to nothing.

Independent for Life Monthly picks up where Day 42 leaves off: fresh programming every month, your cohort training alongside you, a retest every 3 months, and The Steady Letter with real form corrections every month. Three tiers:

- **Monthly (\$97)** — programming, community, retest, newsletter.
- **Monthly Plus (\$147)** — adds 1:1 text access to your coach.
- **Monthly Best (\$197)** — adds personal 1:1 video form corrections.

Your coach will walk you through the options in Week 6. Founding members lock their rate for life.

WEEK 6 — Taper + prove (lighter, then test)

Sessions 16–17 are deliberately lighter — 2 rounds, moderate loads, crisp movement. You're not getting weaker; you're sharpening. Session 18 is the guarantee test. Rest 2–3 minutes between the test events.

Session 16 — A: Lower + carry (taper)

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby ☐ walking path clear. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up: standard.

Main — 2 rounds, moderate: 1. Chair squat × 8 (unassisted as able — practice, don't grind) 2. Dumbbell Romanian deadlift × 8 (moderate) 3. Step-up × 6 per leg 4. Calf raise × 12 5. Farmer's carry — 10 lb each hand, 45s — tall (feel the test weight, don't chase it) 6. Single-leg stand — unassisted, comfortable holds

Rest 60–90s between rounds. **Cool-down:** standard.

Session 17 — B/C: Full body (taper)

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby ☐ walking path clear. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up: standard.

Main — 2 rounds, moderate: 1. Chair squat × 8 2. Countertop push-up × 8 3. Dumbbell bent row × 8 per arm 4. Dowel hip hinge × 10 (groove the pattern — light and perfect) 5. Farmer's carry — 10 lb each hand, 45s 6. Heel-to-toe walk — 45s 7. Single-leg stand — unassisted, comfortable holds 8. Face pull (band) × 10, light — elbows high; taper-day shoulder care

Rest 60–90s between rounds. **Cool-down:** standard.

Day before the test: rest. Walk, stretch, sleep. You've done the work.

Session 18 — THE GUARANTEE TEST

Before you start: ☐ floor clear ☐ chair sturdy, no wheels ☐ water nearby ☐ walking path clear ☐ two 10-lb dumbbells ready. Stop for sharp pain, dizziness, or chest pain.

Warm-up: standard (full 5 minutes — treat this like it matters, because it does).

The three tests — rest 2–3 minutes between events, same setup as Day 1:

1. **Chair stand:** arms crossed over your chest, sturdy chair — 5 full stand-ups without using your hands. Clean reps: full stand, controlled sit, no pushing off knees. - Day 1: **_ reps → Day 42: _ / 5**
2. **Carry:** two 10-lb dumbbells (20 lbs total), walk ~20 feet and back. Tall posture, steady pace, no shrugging, no leaning. - Day 1: **_____ lbs → Day 42: 20 lbs, posture held? Y / N**
3. **Single-leg stand:** near the wall, unassisted, 30 seconds per leg. Eyes open, keep breathing. - Day 1: **right _ s / left s → Day 42: right _ s / left _____ s**

Then celebrate honestly: compare every number to Day 1. Write them in the tracker. Text your coach all three results — pass or not, the numbers are yours and they're real.

Cool-down: standard — you've earned the slow breathing.

Fuel & troubleshooting (the short version)

Fuel. Protein at every meal — a palm-sized portion, roughly 1.2–1.6 g per kg of bodyweight across the day for active adults over 50 (your doctor's number outranks ours if you have one). A protein anchor within the hour after sessions. Water with every meal. Sleep 7+ hours — under that, your loads will lie to you.

Troubleshooting. Sore muscles for a day: training working. Joint pain, pain that's sharp or worse on day three: drop one level and tell your coach. Missed sessions are rescheduled, never doubled. A stalled movement is information for your coach, not a verdict on you — that's what the weekly form check is for.

Send us your numbers. Self-study members: photograph this tracker at Week 4 and again on Day 42 and email it to flbesttrainer@gmail.com. Coaching members: your coach already sees them — the same pages drive your Week 4 and Day 42 reviews.

After the test

If you passed all three: you did what the program promised. Now the honest truth — six weeks built the foundation, but strength is a use-it-or-lose-it asset. Your coach will lay out the maintenance and next-level plan: heavier loading, new patterns, and the long game of staying independent for life. The worst thing you can do now is stop.

If you missed one: that's data, not failure. The guarantee stands — you keep coaching until you pass, or you get refunded. Either way, your coach reviews your numbers, finds the gap (usually one pattern needs more time), and programs the next block around it. Most near-misses close within 2–4 weeks of targeted work.

Either way: keep the tracker. In a year, these numbers will tell a story worth reading.

How coaching works in this program

This isn't a PDF you do alone. Your coach is in the program with you:

- **Form-video review, weekly.** Film one set of the week's key movement (your coach tells you which one), send it in, get specific corrections. This is how "am I doing this right?" gets answered with certainty.
- **Text check-ins.** Your coach checks your streak, your loads, and your numbers. When a movement stalls, the program adjusts — that's the point of coaching.
- **The guarantee.** If you complete all 18 sessions and send your weekly form-check videos and still can't hit all three standards on Day 42 — **5 clean chair stands without using your hands, the 20-lb carry, the 30-second single-leg stand** — you keep coaching free until you can, or you get every cent back. No forms, no interrogation.

Your tracker (print this page)

The three abilities

Test	Day 1	Week 4 (informal)	Day 42	Goal met?
Chair stand, arms crossed (reps)				5 unassisted
Carry (lbs total / posture held)	/	/	/	20 lbs, tall
Single-leg stand, right (sec, unassisted?)	/	/	/	30 s
Single-leg stand, left (sec, unassisted?)	/	/	/	30 s

Sessions completed

Week	Session	Done	Notes (loads used, holds, what improved)
1	1 — A + baseline	☐	
1	2 — B	☐	
1	3 — C	☐	
2	4 — A	☐	
2	5 — B	☐	
2	6 — C	☐	
3	7 — A	☐	
3	8 — B	☐	
3	9 — C	☐	
4	10 — A	☐	
4	11 — B	☐	
4	12 — C	☐	
5	13 — A	☐	
5	14 — B	☐	
5	15 — C	☐	
6	16 — A (taper)	☐	
6	17 — B/C (taper)	☐	
6	18 — TEST	☐	

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Questions about a movement, a pain, or whether you're ready for the next step? Ask your coach — that's what they're for.